

D188

The Collaborative Leader

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

A fourth-grade team that recently moved into a new wing meets weekly. Their meetings are spent on field-trip logistics and a shared novel study for adults. The principal wants them to function as a PLC. What change fits best?

- A. Keep the novel study, since reading together builds collaboration.
- B. Meet in the new wing's conference room.
- C. Use common assessment results to decide which students need reteaching or extension on shared goals.
- D. Plan field trips more efficiently.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2.

A general education teacher and a special education teacher, who have co-taught for three years, split their class of 28 into two groups of 14. Each teacher teaches the same lesson to one group at the same time. Which model is this?

- A. Parallel teaching.
- B. Alternative teaching.
- C. Team teaching.
- D. Station teaching.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Co-teachers want to pull five students for 15 minutes of pre-teaching vocabulary while the rest of the class continues. Which model should they use?

- A. Parallel teaching.
- B. Alternative teaching.
- C. One teach, one observe.
- D. One teach, one assist, always the best choice.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A district plans a single-day workshop with a nationally known speaker in its large auditorium to launch a new writing curriculum. What change would most improve the PD?

- A. Book a more famous speaker.
- B. Make the workshop two days long instead of one.
- C. Send teachers links to online videos only.
- D. Add ongoing, job-embedded coaching and team work sessions on the curriculum across the year.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Teachers attended a two-hour session with no follow-up, and classroom practice did not change. Which missing feature most likely explains this?

- A. Better snacks and a nicer room.
- B. Nothing; PD never changes practice.
- C. A longer single session.
- D. Sustained, job-embedded support such as coaching.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

After a PD series held in a newly renovated training center, 92% of teachers rated it “excellent.” The leader wants to know whether students benefited. What evidence is still needed?

- A. Student learning outcomes, along with evidence teachers used the new skills.
- B. A 92% rating proves students benefited.
- C. More satisfaction ratings.
- D. A review of the training center.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Classroom walkthroughs show 70% of teachers now use the questioning strategy taught in PD. Which evaluation level does this evidence address?

- A.** Student learning outcomes.
- B.** Participants' use of new knowledge and skills.
- C.** Participants' learning.
- D.** Participants' reactions.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A grade-level team with a strong record of winning grants has meetings where two members talk most of the time and discussion drifts to complaints. Meetings are held in the library after school. What should the teacher leader do?

- A.** Ask the two talkative members to lead every meeting.
- B.** Have the team set written norms and use a structured protocol for discussing student work.
- C.** Cancel meetings, since adults should not need structure.
- D.** Move meetings to a different room.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A school with a new marquee sign sends a weekly English-only newsletter and holds two family nights a year. Many families speak Spanish or Vietnamese and work evenings. Which step most strengthens family engagement?

- A.** Send the newsletter twice a week.
- B.** Add a third evening family night.
- C.** Post updates on the marquee sign.
- D.** Offer translated two-way contact, such as short calls or messages at flexible times, asking families about their children's strengths and goals.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A team of six, meeting in a sunny classroom, discusses a new homework policy. After all views are heard, four prefer it and two would have chosen differently but say they can support it. Has the team reached consensus?

- A.** No, because six members is too few.
- B.** Not yet; the team must now hold a majority vote.
- C.** Yes, because every member can support the decision.
- D.** No, because not everyone ranked it first.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

After discussion, one team member says she cannot support the decision and will not carry it out. What is true?

- A.** Consensus is reached if most agree.
- B.** Consensus is reached once the leader decides.
- C.** Consensus has not been reached.
- D.** The team must drop the topic permanently.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A popular local restaurant chain with 12 locations offers to sponsor a school event if students hand out its coupons in class. The school's goal this year is improving ninth-grade reading. What is the best response?

- A.** Propose a partnership tied to the reading goal, such as sponsored books or volunteer reading mentors, with clear roles.
- B.** Accept because the chain is large.
- C.** Refuse all business partnerships.
- D.** Accept, since any business support helps.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer C Concept 1

A fourth-grade team ~~that recently moved into a new wing~~ meets weekly. Their meetings are spent on field-trip logistics and a shared novel study for adults. The principal wants them to function as a PLC. What change fits best?

Target word: PLC focus **Decides:** PLCs work on learning goals and evidence.

A	Adjacent category	Collegial, but not focused on student learning.
B	Camouflage	The room does not change the work.
C	Correct	Focuses on learning and results.
D	Dropped element	Logistics leave out learning evidence.

2. Answer A Concept 2

A general education teacher and a special education teacher, ~~who have co-taught for three years~~, split their class of 28 into two groups of 14. Each teacher teaches the same lesson to one group at the same time. Which model is this?

Target word: name the model **Decides:** Split class, same content, simultaneous.

A	Correct	Two groups, same content, at once.
B	Adjacent category	One teacher takes a small group for a specific need.
C	Confusion set	Both teachers lead the whole class together.
D	Confusion set	Stations have different content that students rotate through.

3. Answer B Concept 2 · transfer

Co-teachers want to pull five students for 15 minutes of pre-teaching vocabulary while the rest of the class continues. Which model should they use?

Target word: choose the model from the goal **Decides:** Small group with a specific need.

A	Confusion set	Splits the class evenly with the same content.
B	Correct	One teacher works with a small group for a specific purpose.
C	Inverted operation	The second teacher collects data rather than teaching.
D	Absolute language	Model choice depends on purpose.

4. Answer D Concept 3

A district plans a single-day workshop ~~with a nationally known speaker in its large auditorium~~ to launch a new writing curriculum. What change would most improve the PD?

Target word: improve PD design **Decides:** One-time events rarely change practice.

A	Camouflage	Speaker fame does not fix a one-time format.
B	Wrong stem number	Still a short, one-time event.
C	Adjacent category	Passive and not collaborative.
D	Correct	Sustained, collaborative, content-focused PD.

5. Answer D Concept 3 · transfer

Teachers attended a two-hour session with no follow-up, and classroom practice did not change. Which missing feature most likely explains this?

Target word: diagnose from the result **Decides:** No sustained, job-embedded follow-up.

A	Adjacent category	Affects reactions, not practice.
B	Absolute language	Well-designed PD can.
C	Inverted operation	More time in one sitting is still not sustained.
D	Correct	Change in practice needs follow-up over time.

6. Answer A Concept 4

After a PD series ~~held in a newly renovated training center~~, 92% of teachers rated it “excellent.” The leader wants to know whether students benefited. What evidence is still needed?

Target word: which level is missing **Decides:** Ratings are reactions; the question is about students.

A	Correct	The highest levels link PD to students.
B	Wrong stem number	Satisfaction does not show impact.
C	Dropped element	Still only reactions.
D	Camouflage	The facility is not evidence of impact.

7. Answer B Concept 4 · transfer

Classroom walkthroughs show 70% of teachers now use the questioning strategy taught in PD. Which evaluation level does this evidence address?

Target word: name the level from the evidence **Decides:** Observed use of new skills.

A	Adjacent category	Teacher use is not yet student results.
B	Correct	Walkthroughs show classroom use.
C	Inverted operation	Learning is shown by what teachers know, before classroom use.
D	Confusion set	Reactions are opinions of the PD.

8. Answer B Concept 5

A grade-level team ~~with a strong record of winning grants~~ has meetings where two members talk most of the time and discussion drifts to complaints. ~~Meetings are held in the library after school.~~ What should the teacher leader do?

Target word: fix team process **Decides:** Uneven voices and drifting talk.

A	Inverted operation	Deepens the imbalance.
B	Correct	Norms and protocols balance voice and keep focus.
C	Absolute language	Teams benefit from agreed structure.
D	Camouflage	Location is not the problem.

9. Answer D Concept 6

A school ~~with a new marquee sign~~ sends a weekly English-only newsletter and holds two family nights a year. Many families speak Spanish or Vietnamese and work evenings. Which step most strengthens family engagement?

Target word: best engagement step **Decides:** Needs two-way, accessible, asset-based contact.

A	Dropped element	Still one-way and in one language.
B	Adjacent category	Still event-based and at hours families work.
C	Camouflage	One-way and not accessible.
D	Correct	Two-way, accessible, and values family knowledge.

10. Answer C Concept 7

A team of six, ~~meeting in a sunny classroom~~, discusses a new homework policy. After all views are heard, four prefer it and two would have chosen differently but say they can support it. Has the team reached consensus?

Target word: test for consensus **Decides:** All can support the decision after being heard.

A	Wrong stem number	Group size does not decide consensus.
B	Confusion set	Treats consensus and majority vote as the same process.
C	Correct	Consensus is support, not first choice.
D	Absolute language	Confuses consensus with unanimity.

11. Answer C Concept 7 • transfer

After discussion, one team member says she cannot support the decision and will not carry it out. What is true?

Target word: consensus test — reversed case **Decides:** A member cannot support it.

A	Confusion set	That is majority rule.
B	Adjacent category	That is a leader decision.
C	Correct	Consensus requires that all can support the decision.
D	Absolute language	The team can keep working toward agreement.

12. Answer A Concept 8

A popular local restaurant chain ~~with 12 locations~~ offers to sponsor a school event if students hand out its coupons in class. The school's goal this year is improving ninth-grade reading. What is the best response?

Target word: partnership fit **Decides:** The offer does not align with the goal.

A	Correct	Aligns the partnership with school goals and benefits both sides.
B	Camouflage	Size does not make it a fit.
C	Inverted operation	Rejects a partner that could help if aligned.
D	Absolute language	Not all help fits school goals.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	3	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	3	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	7	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	5	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	6	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	6	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	6	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Professional learning communities	A PLC team works on four questions: what should students learn, how will we know, what if they don't, and what if they already have, using common assessment results.	Calling any staff meeting or book club a PLC.	How a team spends its collaborative time.
2	Co-teaching models	One teach/one observe, one teach/one assist, station teaching, parallel teaching (split class, same content), alternative teaching (small group for a specific need), and team teaching (both lead together).	Confusing parallel teaching with station teaching, or defaulting to one teach/one assist.	A description of how two teachers share a class.
3	Features of effective professional development	Effective PD is sustained over time, job-embedded, content-focused, uses active learning and collaboration, and includes coaching and feedback.	Treating a one-day workshop with a famous speaker as effective PD.	A PD plan to judge or improve.
4	Levels of PD evaluation	Evaluate PD at five levels: participants' reactions, participants' learning, organizational support, participants' use of new skills, and student learning outcomes.	Judging PD by satisfaction surveys alone.	Evidence collected after PD and a question about what it shows.
5	Norms and protocols	Teams agree on written norms for how they work and use structured protocols so every voice is heard and talk stays on evidence.	Assuming professional adults do not need agreed norms.	A meeting dominated by a few voices or drifting off task.
6	Two-way, asset-based family engagement	Strong family partnerships use two-way communication, value families' knowledge and culture, and link engagement to learning.	Equating engagement with one-way newsletters or attendance at events.	A plan for reaching families and a choice among approaches.
7	Consensus decision-making	Consensus means every member can live with and support the decision after all views are heard; it is not unanimity or majority vote.	Thinking consensus requires everyone to agree it is their top choice.	A team decision and a question about whether consensus was reached.
8	Mutually beneficial community partnerships	Community partnerships work best when aligned to school goals, with clear roles and benefits for both sides.	Accepting any offer of help even when it does not fit school goals.	A partnership offer and a question about fit.

Course scope (public description): The Collaborative Leader demonstrates strategies teacher leaders can use to collaborate with other professionals, families, and communities to build strong relationships and improve school

effectiveness. This course examines models of collaboration and the benefits and challenges of collaboration. It also examines the characteristics of effective professional development and explains how to collaboratively design effective professional development opportunities for educators. Finally, this course demonstrates how accomplished teachers can build relationships with families and the community to create a positive learning experience for students. There are no prerequisites for this course.